

NATURAL ACCEPTANCE

(i) Definition

Natural Acceptance refers to the **innate and fundamental ability within every human being to understand what is right and what is wrong**. It is not influenced by external factors such as social rules, fear, punishment, or reward. Instead, it arises from within us and helps us decide what leads to our **long-term happiness and inner harmony**. Natural acceptance provides a constant guideline for our thoughts, behaviors, and decisions. It acts as an internal compass that helps us evaluate whether an action is correct or harmful. Since it is present naturally in every human being, it does not need to be forced or taught; we simply need to pay attention to our inner feelings.

(ii) How do you make out if it is your Natural Acceptance or not?

To identify whether a thought, decision, or action matches our natural acceptance, we can evaluate it through several inner checks.

First, we must check if the decision gives us **self-satisfaction and peace**. If something feels right deep inside, without creating confusion, it generally aligns with natural acceptance.

Second, natural acceptance is **consistent at all times**. If a value or action feels right today, it will feel right tomorrow and in the future. For example, kindness, honesty, and respect always feel correct, no matter the situation.

Third, we should check whether the action leads to **long-term happiness** instead of temporary pleasure. Natural acceptance never promotes actions that bring guilt, conflict, or regret.

Fourth, if the decision is **universal**, meaning it would be right not only for us but for any human being, then it matches natural acceptance. For example, no one naturally accepts violence or dishonesty.

Finally, natural acceptance does not create **inner conflict**. If our mind and heart are calm after a decision, it means the decision aligns with our true nature.

(iii) Characteristics of Natural Acceptance

1. Innate and Spontaneous:

Natural acceptance exists naturally within every human being. It is not learned from outside; instead, it emerges from our inner self whenever we reflect honestly. Even a child shows spontaneous liking for love, care, and truth.

2. Universal:

Natural acceptance is the same for all human beings. Everyone prefers truth over lies, respect over insult, peace over conflict, and happiness over suffering. These values do not differ from person to person.

3. Unchanging and Timeless:

It remains constant throughout life. What is right according to natural acceptance will always be right. It does not change with age, society, time, culture, or place.

4. Guides Human Behavior:

Natural acceptance acts as an internal guideline for our choices and behavior. When we evaluate our actions based on natural acceptance, we choose what is responsible, respectful, and helpful for ourselves and others.

5. Unconditional:

Natural acceptance is not based on external rewards or punishments. It does not depend on whether we gain something or lose something. It is purely driven by inner understanding.

6. Promotes Inner Harmony:

When our thoughts and actions match natural acceptance, we feel peaceful, satisfied, and mentally stable. There is no inner conflict, confusion, or guilt. This inner harmony improves our relationships and overall well-being.

(iv) Examples from My Own Life

1. Helping a friend in need:

Once, my friend was struggling with an assignment and felt stressed. Even though I was busy, I felt a natural urge to support them. Helping them gave me satisfaction and made me feel peaceful inside. This shows that cooperation and care are naturally acceptable to me.

2. Apologizing after a mistake:

When I accidentally hurt someone with my words, my mind felt disturbed. I realized that apologizing was the right thing to do. After I said sorry, I felt relieved and peaceful. This incident showed me that honesty and responsibility align with my natural acceptance.

3. Choosing honesty in an exam:

During an exam, I had the chance to copy answers easily. However, something inside me rejected the idea. Choosing honesty gave me confidence and self-respect, even though it was difficult. This experience reflects that honesty is naturally acceptable to me.

Conclusion

Natural acceptance is the foundation of human values and ethical living. When we align our actions with natural acceptance, we experience both **inner harmony** and **harmonious relationships** with others. It guides us to choose what is right, universal, and unchanging, leading to a meaningful and fulfilling life.